

it's simple to use. Drag and drop clips to the window and follow the step-by-step guide to add an introductory DVD menu or a soundtrack for DVD slideshows of digital images. It's not as sophisticated as some paid-for DVD creation tools but this lack of complexity translates into simplicity for those who don't need the bells and whistles.



Mobility Center keeps your portables in power

21. Speed up Quicklaunch

The Quicklaunch toolbar that runs along the bottom-left side of the display in Vista is, unsurprisingly, a quick way to launch your favourite applications. If you find your mouse a bit of a bore, then Vista introduces a keyboard shortcut that gets those programs started even faster. Just hold down the Windows key and tap the number key that indicates its position on the toolbar. For example, to launch the first program from the left use the Windows key and 1.

22. Put on a Sideshow

Remember the Gadgets we discussed earlier? Well, Vista has an way of putting these to good use away from your PC. A feature called Windows Sideshow takes the Gadget and uses it to display the information it provides on a screen belonging to another device, such as the small display built into the lid of some laptops, a digital photo frame or a compatible mobile phone. So you can view the latest headlines, display your appointments or view digital photos.

23. Bolster your security

Vista includes a new Security Center that enables you to monitor and adjust security settings and updates in a single Window. Unlike XP's version, Vista's Security Center also shows any third-party software that is protecting your PC, instead of simply saying the computer is unprotected when Windows Firewall is not switched on. You can also manage how vital security updates are downloaded and installed.

24. Keep you in power

If you own a laptop and carry it around then you will know how

important it is to keep an eye on battery life. The Vista Mobility Center brings together options for wireless connections, display brightness and power management, so you can get the most efficient use from the battery. This feature also makes it easy to synchronise data between devices such as mobile phones and the computer.

25. Recognise your scrawl

Although intended for the largely defunct tablet PC, Vista's handwriting-recognition tools work perfectly with a touchscreen or a graphics tablet. Similar to the speech recognition tool we discussed earlier, you can use this method to control your PC and input text using a pen or stylus instead of a mouse and keyboard. It's not included in Home Basic.